

Nehemiah and Ezra read God's Word.

Nehemiah 8

For many years, God's people did not obey God's Word. So God let an army take them from their homes to live in a faraway country. But God had promised to bring them back to Israel. And He did! But the people still didn't obey or remember God's Word.

Nehemiah and Ezra were two of the leaders who came back to Israel. These men loved God and wanted to obey Him. But the people they led back to Israel did not know what God's Word said. The people did not know how to love and obey God. Nehemiah and Ezra sent a message to all the people, inviting them to come together.

Soon hundreds and hundreds of people gathered together. Ezra climbed on a high platform. Everyone

could see and hear him. When Ezra opened the scroll of God's Word, the people stood up. They stood for hours listening to Ezra and his helpers read God's Word aloud. They heard how God had cared for them for many years. Ezra and Nehemiah helped the people understand God's Word.

God's people learned that they had not obeyed God. Many people cried as they listened. But Ezra told them it was not a day to cry. It was a day to celebrate! Now they knew what God wanted them to do! Now they could obey Him! The people celebrated by eating together and sharing food with others. And the next day they listened to even more of God's Word!